# MINISTRY OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE (MoHFW) - GOVT. OF INDIA

India-Adapted WHO Medical Eligibility Criteria (MEC) for Contraceptive Use

## 1. Executive Summary & National Program Guidelines

The Medical Eligibility Criteria (MEC) Wheel for Contraceptive Use - India (2022 Update) has been formulated by the Family Planning Division, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW), Government of India, in technical collaboration with the World Health Organization (WHO) India Country Office. It adapts global WHO evidence-based criteria to align with India's expanded contraceptive basket under Mission Parivar Vikas (MPV).

**MEC Medical Eligibility Categories (1 to 4):**

Category 1 (GREEN): Use method in any circumstance. No restriction on contraceptive use. (YES)

Category 2 (BLUE): Generally use the method. Advantages generally outweigh theoretical or proven risks. (YES)

Category 3 (ORANGE): Use of method not usually recommended unless other methods unavailable. (NO*)

Category 4 (RED): Method NOT to be used. Unacceptable health risk. Absolute contraindication. (NO)

## 2. Key National Contraceptive Methods & Special Directives

### Centchroman (Ormeloxifene - Chhaya / Saheli):

Indigenous non-steroidal, non-hormonal SERM. Dosing: Twice weekly for the first 3 months (e.g., Sun & Wed), then once weekly thereafter on the first designated day. Safe during any stage of lactation. Free of estrogenic/progestational vascular risks. 8-10% of users experience delayed periods in first 3 months (benign pharmacological effect).

### Antara Programme (DMPA - 150 mg IM / 104 mg SC):

3-monthly progestogen-only injectable. Given within first 7 days of menses, immediately postpartum (<48 hours) or 6 weeks postpartum if breastfeeding. Window period: Up to 2 weeks early or up to 4 weeks late without requiring backup contraception.

### Copper IUCD (Cu-IUCD 380A & Cu-IUCD 375):

Cu-380A provides 10-year protection; Cu-375 provides 5-year protection. Postpartum IUCD (PPIUCD) can be safely inserted post-placental (within 10 min), intracesarean, or within 48 hours of delivery. If >48 hours elapsed, defer insertion to 6 weeks postpartum.

### Female & Male Sterilization Guidelines (A, C, D, S):

Categorized as A (Accept), C (Caution), D (Delay), and S (Special). Male sterilization (Non-Scalpel Vasectomy - NSV) is preferred. Condom backup required for 3 months post-vasectomy until azoospermia is confirmed.

## 3. High-Priority Conditions & Contraindications Quick Table

| Medical Condition | COCs & CICs | Chhaya | Antara / DMPA | Cu-IUCD | LNG-IUD |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Severe Hypertension (>= 160 / >= 100) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 1 (Safe) | 3 (Caution) | 1 (Safe) | 2 (Generally Use) |
| Migraine with Aura (Any age) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 1 (Safe) | 2 (Generally Use) | 1 (Safe) | 2 (Generally Use) |
| Smoking >= 35 years (>=15 cigs/day) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) |
| Deep Vein Thrombosis (Acute DVT/PE) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 1 (Safe) | 2 (Generally Use) | 1 (Safe) | 2 (Generally Use) |
| Breast Cancer (Current) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 1 (Safe) | 4 (Contraindicated) |
| Postpartum < 48 Hours (Breastfeeding) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe - MPV) | 1 (Safe - PPIUCD) | 2 (Generally Use) |
| Postpartum 48 hrs to 6 weeks | 4 (Contraindicated) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 3 (Delay insertion) | 3 (Delay insertion) |
| Current PID / Purulent Cervicitis | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 4 (Contraindicated) |
| Unexplained Vaginal Bleeding | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 2 (Generally Use) | 4 (Evaluate 1st) | 4 (Evaluate 1st) |
| Tuberculosis on Rifampicin (ATT) | 3 (Interacts) | 2 (Can use) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) |
| Epilepsy on Enzyme Inducers | 3 (Interacts) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) | 1 (Safe) |
| Severe Decompensated Cirrhosis | 4 (Contraindicated) | 4 (Contraindicated) | 3 (Caution) | 1 (Safe) | 3 (Caution) |

## 4. Emergency Contraceptive Pills (ECPs) & Lactational Amenorrhea (LAM)

- Levonorgestrel ECP (1.5 mg single dose): Must be taken as early as possible within 72 hours of unprotected intercourse.
- Ulipristal Acetate (30 mg): Can be taken up to 120 hours (5 days) post-coitus with higher efficacy in overweight women.
- Cu-IUCD as Emergency Contraception: Insertion within 5 days is >99% effective and provides long-term ongoing contraception.
- LAM 3 Criteria: (1) Baby <6 months of age, (2) Exclusive breastfeeding day and night, (3) Mother remains amenorrhoeic.

**Official Clinical Sources:**

1. Ministry of Health & Family Welfare (MoHFW), Nirman Bhawan, New Delhi - Reference Manual for MEC Wheel (2022).
2. World Health Organization (WHO) - Medical Eligibility Criteria for Contraceptive Use (5th Edition 2015 / India Update).
3. Clinikkit Digital Health Suite (https://clinikkit.web.app/tools/obstetrics/india-mec-wheel/)